

ENGLISH LANGUAGE PAPER 4

PART A Group Interaction

This review appeared in a tech magazine:

Apple Screen Time Control



Are your children always on their phones and iPads? Do you, as a parent, worry about the websites your children are visiting? Does your family argue over screen time?

The answer may well be Apple's new Screen Time Control.

Screen Time Control is a new app that allows parents to manage the amount of time their children spend on their iPad or iPhone by using their own iPhone to check the websites or apps their children are using.

Screen Time Control also has a feature called "Downtime". This allows parents to block certain apps and to set up a time limit of how long children can spend on their phones. That means no more late-night phone calls, unlimited playing of online games or watching YouTube videos.

With Apple Screen Time Control, when apps run past the time limit, their icons go dark and the apps simply won't work. Useful apps, such as e-books or homework sites or messaging for emergencies are not affected.

Apple already has parental controls for blocking certain movies, adult websites and podcasts with explicit language but this new feature will allow parents better control over how children use their devices.

So a neat new app to help parenting, although I would always recommend that it is best for families to have serious conversations about screen time. It's only through a mutual understanding about why the restrictions are imposed that all family members can understand them.

Your school is holding a meeting to introduce Apple's Screen Time Control to students and parents. Your group is meeting to discuss the idea. You may want to talk about:

- whether parents should control students' screen time
- advantages and disadvantages of Apple Screen Time Control
- whether software like Apple Screen Time Control is the best way to limit students' screen time
- anything else you think is important

PART B Individual Response

1. Do you spend a lot of time online?
2. Does being online affect your homework?
3. Would you like your parents to control your screen time?
4. Why do you think students spend so much time on their phones?
5. What is the biggest problem caused by too much screen time?
6. Does spending time on your phone affect family relationships?
7. Should parents know everything their children do online?
8. Can students be trusted to control their own screen time?